# Text-message nudges to reduce course withdrawal: a pragmatic randomised trial

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## Abstract

Community-college students were randomised to weekly text-message nudges or no messages. Course withdrawal fell from 13.3% to 11.2% (risk ratio 0.84).

## 1. Methods

Design: pragmatic individually randomised trial. Participants: 2,904 students enrolled at three community colleges. Intervention: weekly text messages with deadline reminders and links to tutoring. Comparator: no messages (usual communication). Primary outcome: withdrawal from at least one course by the end of term.

## 2. Results

Withdrawal occurred in 11.2% of the nudge group and 13.3% of the control group (risk ratio 0.84, 95% CI 0.73 to 0.97).

## 3. Limitations

Outcomes came from college records only, and the messages were sent in English only.

*Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.*